Firstake AI Tool Catalog

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How to use this catalog

This catalog is Firstake's routing brain: for each major AI tool it records what the tool is best at, what it costs, what happens when credits run out, and how it likes to be prompted. It covers the leading tools in ten categories as of late October 2026, not every AI product in existence; new tools are added by filling the same fields.

Fields per tool (these become the database columns in Claude Code):

Field	What it holds	Why Firstake needs it
Category	e.g. image, video, website	First routing step
Best at	The 1–2 jobs it wins	Matches user intent to tool
Weak at	Known failure modes	Steers users away early
Free tier / credits	What you get without paying, and how credits refill	Solves the "I ran out of credits" problem
Paid entry price	Cheapest paid plan, USD/month	Budget-aware routing
API	Yes / no / limited	Whether Firstake can call it directly or only hand off a prompt
Prompt style	Natural language, tags, structured fields, parameters	Drives the prompt template
Free fallback	Closest free alternative	Where to send users when credits are gone
Last verified	Date checked	Prices and limits change monthly

Rules for the data: prices and credit amounts change often and vary by region, so every row should be re-verified on its vendor's pricing page before launch. Figures below come from vendor pages and recent reviews; treat them as approximate until checked. The prompt rules for each tool will live in a separate doc.

Neutrality rules (Firstake has no favorite):

1. Rank by fit first: does the tool actually do the job well (quality, licensing, output format)? Tools that fail the job are dropped before price is considered.
2. Among tools that pass, rank by cost per finished output (per image, per second of video, per song, per million tokens), not by monthly sticker price. A $30 plan that makes 900 images beats a $10 plan that makes 200 if the user needs 500.
3. Always show the user the top pick, the cheapest good pick, and the free option, with prices next to each, so the user makes the final call.
4. No affiliate deals, sponsored placement or hidden markups in the ranking. If Firstake ever earns referral fees, they are disclosed and never change the order.
5. Every price carries a last-verified date; anything older than 30 days is flagged as "may have changed."

1. General chat assistants

No single chatbot wins everything in 2026; the common pattern is Claude for writing and code, ChatGPT as the all-rounder, Gemini for Google users, Perplexity for cited research. Free tiers diverged sharply in October 2026: ChatGPT Free is unlimited text with ads, Claude Free is message-capped, and Gemini Free dropped to Flash-Lite on 9 October 2026 (SSD Nodes).

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	API	Prompt style
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	All-round tasks, images in chat, agents	Hallucinates more on niche topics	Unlimited text on smallest model, ads; limited images	Go ~$8, Plus $20	Yes	Natural language; role + context + format
Claude (Anthropic)	Long writing, coding, long documents	No image generation	~15–40 messages per 5-hour window	Pro $20	Yes	Structured context, XML tags, examples
Gemini (Google)	Google Workspace, search, multimodal input	Free model is now Flash-Lite only	Flash-Lite, image gen with limits	AI Plus / AI Pro	Yes	Natural language; benefits from files and links

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	API	Prompt style
Perplexity	Cited research, current facts	Long creative writing	Unlimited basic Sonar searches	Pro ~$20	Yes	Questions, not instructions
Microsoft Copilot	Word, Excel, Teams, Windows	Outside Microsoft apps	Free with Microsoft account	M365 Copilot plans	Via Azure	Task-oriented, file references
Grok (xAI)	Live X/Twitter trends, fewer filters	Reliability, tone	Limited free use	SuperGrok ~$30	Yes	Casual natural language
DeepSeek	Free reasoning and coding, cheap API	Data stored in China; sensitive topics	No stated chat limits	API pay-as-you-go	Yes, very cheap	Direct, step-by-step
Meta AI	Casual help inside WhatsApp/Instagram	Depth, professional work	Fully free, ad-supported	None	Llama open models	Short conversational
Mistral Le Chat	Privacy, EU hosting, multilingual	Smaller ecosystem	Free tier	Pro plan	Yes	Natural language

Credit-saving rule for Firstake: when Claude hits its cap, route text work to ChatGPT Free or DeepSeek; route research to Perplexity's free searches (Zemith, Tech Insider).

1b. LLM model lineup with prices

Every major lab sells several model tiers: a top model, a mid model, and a cheap fast model. Firstake should route simple jobs (summaries, rewrites, short answers) to the cheap tiers and save top tiers for hard reasoning or long documents. API prices are USD per million tokens (input / output), first-party standard rates as of 10 October 2026 (IntuitionLabs); consumer app prices are monthly.

Lab	Model tier	API price (in / out per 1M tokens)	Consumer app price	Use it for
OpenAI	gpt-6-astra (top)	$10 / $50	ChatGPT Pro $100–200	Hardest reasoning
OpenAI	gpt-6.1-sol (mid)	$2 / $10	ChatGPT Plus $20	Most everyday work

Lab	Model tier	API price (in / out per 1M tokens)	Consumer app price	Use it for
OpenAI	gpt-6-luna (cheap)	$0.10 / $0.50	ChatGPT Free (ads), Go ~$8	High-volume simple tasks
OpenAI	GPT-5 nano	$0.05 / $0.40	—	Cheapest major model
Anthropic	Claude Fable 5.1 (top)	$10 / $50	Claude Max $100–200	Long agentic and research tasks
Anthropic	Claude Opus 5.5	$4 / $20	Claude Pro $20	Writing, coding, long documents
Anthropic	Claude Sonnet 5.5 (mid)	$2 / $10	Claude Free (capped), Pro $20	Balanced default
Anthropic	Claude Haiku 5.5 (cheap)	$0.10 / $0.50 (under 100K-token prompts)	—	Fast, cheap tasks
Google	Gemini 3.1 Pro	$2 / $12 (doubles above 200K tokens)	Google AI Pro $19.99	Multimodal, Google apps
Google	Gemini 3.8 Flash	$0.75 / $3.75 (rises to $1.50 / $7.50 on 1 Jan 2027)	AI Plus $7.99	Fast general use
Google	Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite	$0.25 / $1.50	Gemini Free	Cheapest Google tier
xAI	grok-4.7	$2 / $6	SuperGrok ~$30	Live X/Twitter context
xAI	grok-4.3	$1.25 / $2.50	—	Cheap 1M-token context
DeepSeek	deepseek-v4-pro	$1.32 / $3.96 (half off-peak)	Free chat app	Cheap reasoning and code
DeepSeek	deepseek-flash (V4.1)	$0.30 / $1.20 (half off-peak)	Free chat app	Cheapest strong model at night (US time)

Lab	Model tier	API price (in / out per 1M tokens)	Consumer app price	Use it for
Meta	Muse Spark (app) / Llama 4 (open)	Free to self-host; varies by host	Free, ad-supported	Casual use in WhatsApp/Instagram
Mistral	Mistral Large 3	~$1.50 output per 1M	Le Chat Free / Pro	EU privacy, multilingual
Alibaba	Qwen (open)	Free to self-host	Qwen Chat free	Free multilingual and coding
Perplexity	Sonar	Via API	Free; Pro ~$20	Cited web answers

Price spread: the same 1M output tokens costs $0.40 on GPT-5 nano and $50 on gpt-6-astra or Claude Fable 5.1, a 125x difference. This is where Firstake's cost routing saves users the most.

2. Image generation and editing

Route by the job, not by the brand: GPT Image 2 is the all-round default, Nano Banana Pro and FLUX 2 lead photorealism, Midjourney leads artistic style, Ideogram leads text inside images, and Firefly is the safest for commercial licensing (Riverfront Times, Dupple).

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	Cost per image (approx.)	Prompt style
GPT Image 2 (OpenAI)	Following detailed instructions, text, conversational edits	Distinctive art style	A few images/day on ChatGPT Free	ChatGPT Plus $20	Included in plan; API per image	Full sentences; exact text in quotes
Nano Banana Pro / 2 (Google)	Photorealism, editing uploaded photos	Stylized art	Limited quota in Gemini app	Google AI Pro $19.99	Included; API pay-per-image	"Change only X, keep Y" edits

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	Cost per image (approx.)	Prompt style
Midjourney V8.1	Artistic, cinematic looks; also image-to-video	Text in images; no free plan	None	Basic $10, Standard $30, Pro $60, Mega $120	~$0.05 on Basic (~200 images); Standard adds unlimited Relax images	Short phrases + --ar, --stylize, --sref
FLUX 2 (Black Forest Labs)	Photorealism, character consistency, open weights	Needs a host app for beginners	Free if self-hosted	Via hosts	$0.04–0.08 via API	Camera, lens and lighting terms
Ideogram 3.0	Posters, logos, any image with words	Pure photo quality	~10 credits/day	From ~$7	Low	Exact text in quotes; name the layout
Adobe Firefly	Commercially safe images, Photoshop	Cutting-edge quality	Limited credits	Standard $9.99 (2K credits), Pro $19.99, Premium $199.99	Credit-based	Natural language + presets
Leonardo AI	Game assets, consistent characters	Top-end photorealism	~150 tokens/day	From ~$10	Credit-based; tokens roll over up to 3 months	Model + style presets
Recraft V4	Vectors, icons, brand-consistent sets	Photography	Yes	Paid plans	Check vendor	Style + palette specified
Seedream 4.5 (ByteDance)	Fast, high-quality general images	Availability varies by region	Daily credits on Dreamina	Dreamina plans	Low via aggregators	Natural language
Grok Imagine (xAI)	Fast images and video, fewer filters	Safety and consistency	Limited	SuperGrok ~$30	Included	Casual natural language
Stable Diffusion	Free, fully customizable, runs locally	Setup required	Free open source	—	$0 on own computer	Weighted keywords, negative prompts

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	Cost per image (approx.)	Prompt style
Microsoft Designer	Free GPT-Image access	Advanced control	~15 boosts/day	Free	$0	Natural language
Canva AI	Images placed straight into designs	Quality vs. leaders	~200 AI uses	Pro ~$12–15	Included	Short descriptions

Multi-model platforms such as Krea, Freepik and OpenArt are in section 8b.

Credit-saving rule: Microsoft Designer and the Gemini app give free GPT-Image and Nano Banana output; aggregators like Picsart and Freepik host many models under one plan (WPForms, Picsart).

3. Video generation

Google Veo 3.1 is the overall leader, Runway Gen-4.5 leads creative control, and Kling 3.0 leads value. OpenAI discontinued Sora: the web and app closed 26 April 2026 and the API on 24 September 2026, so Firstake must never route to it (Higgsfield, Rangy).

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	API cost per second	Prompt style
Google Veo 3.1	Cinematic clips with synced audio and dialogue, 9:16 vertical	Cost at volume	Limited	AI Plus $7.99 (720p), AI Pro $19.99 (1080p), Ultra (4K)	1080p $0.40, 4K $0.60, Veo 3.1 Lite $0.05 (silent)	Shot by shot: subject, action, camera, style, audio
Runway Gen-4.5	Frame-level control, VFX, editing suite	Burns credits fast on complex motion	125 one-time credits	Standard $12–15, Pro $28, Max/Unlimited $76	~$0.12	Image first; describe motion and camera only

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	API cost per second	Prompt style
Kling 3.0 (Kuaishou)	Realistic human motion, physics, best price-to-quality	Clips max ~10 s; long narratives need stitching	~66 credits/day, refreshes daily	Standard ~$7–10, Pro ~$30–37	~$0.11 (720p Turbo)	Subject + action + camera + mood
Seedance 2.0 (ByteDance)	Cheap cinematic camera motion, audio-video together	Less photoreal; regional availability	Daily credits via Dreamina	Dreamina Basic ~$8–18	~$0.03–0.09 via aggregators	Natural language, camera terms
Grok Imagine Video 1.5 (xAI)	Strong quality for the price	Preset voices only for dialogue	Limited	SuperGrok ~$30	$0.08 (1.0 model $0.05)	Casual natural language
Hailuo 2.3 (MiniMax)	Fast image-to-video, dialogue and characters	Fine control	Daily free credits	Paid plans	~$0.40 per clip via aggregators	Short motion prompts
Luma Ray 3	Image-to-video with first/last frame anchoring	Long clips	Limited	From ~$30	Check vendor	Start/end frames + short motion
Midjourney Video	Animating Midjourney images in its signature style	Text-to-video from scratch	None	Included in $10–120 plans (uses Fast hours)	—	Animate an image; low or high motion
Adobe Firefly Video	Commercially safe, IP-clean clips	Top-end realism	Limited credits	$9.99 (~20 five-second clips), higher tiers to $199.99	Credit-based	Natural language + camera controls
Pika	Playful effects for social clips	Realism	Limited	Paid plans	Check vendor	Short, effect-focused
InVideo AI	Prompt to finished, edited social video with voiceover	Pure generation quality	Yes	From ~$20 (annual)	—	Describe the full video: topic, length, platform
LTX Studio	Storyboards to video, brand kit	Single quick clips	Limited	Paid plans	Check vendor	Script and shot list

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	API cost per second	Prompt style
Wan 2.6 (Alibaba)	Free, open source (Apache 2.0)	Technical setup	Free self-hosted	—	$0 on own GPU	Natural language
Artlist (aggregator)	One plan for Veo, Kling, Seedance, Hailuo and more, commercial license included	Markup vs. going direct	Limited	AI Suite from ~$10–13 (£9.99)	Credit-based	Depends on model chosen
Higgsfield (aggregator)	15+ video models, social-first presets	Premium models drain credits	Limited	Starter $19 (270 credits), Plus $59, Ultra $129	Credit-based	Depends on model chosen
~~Sora 2~~ (OpenAI)	**Discontinued:** app closed 26 Apr 2026, API 24 Sep 2026	—	—	—	—	Redirect to Veo 3.1 or Kling 3.0

Some aggregators still list Sora 2 in their model menus; Firstake should verify a route works before recommending it (invideo, Atlas Cloud, Provimedia).

Credit-saving rule: test ideas on Kling's daily free credits or Veo 3.1 Lite, then spend premium credits only on the final shot.

4. Voice, music and audio

Suno is the default for full songs with vocals, Udio for higher fidelity, and ElevenLabs for anything that must be commercially safe or needs voice and sound effects too (Dupple). Licensing is the key routing question here: free tiers are personal-use only.

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	API	Prompt style
Suno	Full songs with vocals and lyrics, fast	Ongoing copyright litigation	50 credits per day (~10 songs), non-commercial	~$8–10 (commercial use)	No official public API	Genre + mood + instruments + era tags; lyrics in [Verse]/[Chorus] sections

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	API	Prompt style
Udio	Audio fidelity, detailed production	Downloads and sharing restricted on platform	~10 credits per day	~$10	No	Detailed genre and production tags; iterate by extending clips
ElevenLabs	Voiceover, voice cloning, music and sound effects, commercially cleared	Music community features	~10,000 credits per month	Starter $5	Yes	Natural language; tags for emotion and delivery
MiniMax Music	Realistic vocals	Smaller community	One-time free credits	Credit packs	Yes	Lyrics + style description
AIVA	Orchestral and cinematic scores	Vocals	3 downloads per month; AIVA owns copyright	~€11	Limited	Preset styles and keys rather than text
Soundraw / Mubert	Royalty-free background music for video	Full songs with vocals	Preview or attribution-only	Paid plans	Mubert yes	Mood, length, tempo selectors

Rule for Firstake: if the user says the output is for a business, ad or monetized channel, route to ElevenLabs or a paid Suno plan and warn that free-tier songs cannot be used commercially (Fast.io).

Also tracked for music: Google Lyria 3 (inside Gemini and Artlist), Mureka (50 free credits), Boomy (fast songs with Spotify distribution) and Beatoven (background music) (Unite.AI).

5. Website and app builders

The first routing question is "site or app?": Framer, Wix and Squarespace for marketing sites; Lovable, Bolt and Base44 for working apps; v0 for polished interface pieces (Skill Scouter, Beginners in AI).

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	API	Prompt style
Lovable	Non-technical users building full-stack apps with database and login	Locked stack (React + Supabase); credits drain on bug loops	Limited daily credits	~$25	No	Knowledge file with vision, users, design system; one feature per prompt (docs)
Bolt.new	Speed, any framework, Figma import	Less guided for beginners	Limited tokens	~$25	No	Technical, framework named up front
v0 (Vercel)	Best-looking React UI components	Full backends	Limited credits	~$20	Yes	Component-level descriptions, design tokens
Base44	Internal business tools, portals, absolute beginners	Custom design	Limited	Paid plans	No	Plain business language
Replit Agent	Learning, apps with hosting included	Polish of UI	Limited	Paid plans	No	Conversational, step by step
Framer AI	Designer-quality marketing sites and portfolios	Apps with logic	Free site on Framer subdomain	Paid plans	No	Describe sections, tone, brand
Wix (Harmony) / Squarespace (Blueprint)	Small-business sites with booking, store, hosting	Distinctive design	Free tiers with branding	Paid plans	No	Answer guided questions

Prompt rules to carry forward: give real content not placeholders, build one section at a time, and name colors, fonts and a reference site to avoid the generic purple-gradient AI look (Lovable docs).

6. Coding assistants

Coding tools split three ways: editor plugins (GitHub Copilot), AI-native editors (Cursor), and terminal agents (Claude Code, Codex). Most cost about $20 a month; Copilot is cheapest at $10 (AI Weekly). Firstake should route here only users who already write code; beginners go to section 5.

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	Prompt style
Claude Code	Complex multi-file work, large codebases	No inline autocomplete	None; shares usage with Claude Pro	$20 (Claude Pro)	Clear goal, files to touch, constraints, test command
Cursor	All-round AI editor, daily coding	Metered usage can exceed headline price	Limited free	$20	@-mention files; small scoped tasks
GitHub Copilot	Cheapest solid assistant, inline completion	Agent mode trails Cursor and Claude Code	Free tier	$10 (AI-credit billing since June 2026)	Comments describing intent above code
OpenAI Codex	Cloud agent running tasks in parallel	Less predictable cost	Included in ChatGPT plans	ChatGPT Plus $20	Task tickets with acceptance criteria
Windsurf	Budget AI editor	Smaller ecosystem	Free tier	~$15	Similar to Cursor

Google closed individual Gemini Code Assist access on 18 June 2026, so it is not a consumer route (AI Weekly).

7. Presentations and design

Gamma is the default for a fast, modern deck; Canva when the deck feeds other visual content; Plus AI when the user must stay inside Google Slides or PowerPoint; Beautiful.ai for strict brand consistency (Dupple, The Neuron).

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	Prompt style
Gamma	Fast web-native decks, docs and one-page sites	PowerPoint export layout breaks	400 one-time credits (~10 decks), no refill	Plus ~$10	Outline with one line per slide, audience, tone
Canva AI	Decks plus social graphics in one place, templates	No outline step	~200 AI uses	Pro ~$12–15	Short topic description, then edit visually
Plus AI	Native Google Slides and PowerPoint decks	Requires card for trial	7-day trial (1,000 credits)	~$10	Outline or pasted document
Beautiful.ai	Brand-consistent business decks	Weaker AI generation	14-day trial, card required	~$12	Story first, then slides

Tool	Best at	Weak at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	Prompt style
Microsoft Copilot in PowerPoint	Decks from Word documents in Microsoft 365	Outside Microsoft	Microsoft 365 plans	M365 Copilot	Reference a source file

Credit-saving rule: Gamma's free credits never refill, so Firstake should send a user's first deck to Gamma and later decks to Canva Free.

8. Research, avatars, 3D and automation

These smaller categories round out the catalog. Each has one clear default and one free fallback.

Category	Tool	Best at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	Prompt style
Research	Perplexity	Cited answers on current topics	Unlimited basic searches	~$20	Specific questions with timeframe
Research	NotebookLM (Google)	Studying your own files; audio overviews	Free with Google account	Google AI plans	Upload sources, then ask about them
Avatar video	HeyGen	Realistic talking-head marketing video, translation	3 watermarked videos per month	Creator $29	Script + avatar + voice; premium Avatar IV costs 20 credits per minute
Avatar video	Synthesia	Training and onboarding video, predictable pricing	~3 minutes per month	~$29	Script with scene breaks
3D models	Meshy	Most complete text/image-to-3D with rigging	100 credits per month (~3 textured models), CC BY license	~$20	Object + material + style; image input works best
3D models	Tripo	Fast game-ready models, best credit value	~300 credits per month, personal use	$19.90	Same as Meshy; sketches accepted
3D models	Hunyuan 3D (Tencent)	Best truly free generator	~20 generations per day, open source	Free	Image-to-3D preferred

Category	Tool	Best at	Free tier / credits	Paid entry	Prompt style
Automation	Zapier	Non-technical users, 7,000+ app connections, AI steps	100 tasks per month, two-step Zaps	~$20–30	Plain-language Zap description
Automation	n8n	AI agents, RAG, high volume	Free self-hosted, unlimited	Cloud ~€20–24	Node-based workflows
Automation	Make	Complex branching at low cost	1,000 operations per month	Paid plans	Visual scenarios

Sources: Creatify, Krea, Orchestra.

8b. All-in-one platforms (aggregators)

Aggregators resell many models under one subscription and one credit pool. They are often the cheapest route when a user needs several media types, but can cost more than going direct for heavy use of one model. Firstake should compare both every time.

Platform	Covers	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	Credit behavior	Best for
Artlist	Video, image, music, voice, avatars (Veo, Kling, Seedance, Nano Banana, Lyria, ElevenLabs)	Limited	AI Suite from ~$10–13	Monthly credits	Creators needing commercial license on everything
Higgsfield	15+ video models plus image	Limited	$19 / $59 / $129	270 / 1,200 / 3,000 credits	Social video
Freepik (Magnific)	Image and video models plus stock library	Daily credits	$14.50 (annual)	240K credits/year that last a full year	Users who generate in bursts
Krea	60+ image, video and 3D models, real-time canvas	Yes	Basic $5.25 (annual), Pro $35	Monthly units; relax mode after units run out	Cheapest paid entry to many models
OpenArt	100+ models, consistent characters	Trial	Starter $14, Plus $34, Pro $56	Resets monthly; add-on packs roll over	Character consistency
Picsart	30+ image and video models in one editor	Yes	Paid plans	Credit-based	Editing plus generation

Platform	Covers	Free tier	Paid price (USD/mo)	Credit behavior	Best for
OpenRouter	Hundreds of LLMs through one API	Some free models	Pay per token at provider rates	Prepaid balance	Developers comparing LLM costs

Sources: Kive, OpenArt, GetApp.

8c. Add-ons that upgrade a tool (skills, plugins, CLIs, design files)

The big AI tools can be extended with free community add-ons. Most of the ones creators talk about are for Claude Code (Anthropic's coding agent), and many also work in Cursor, Codex and Gemini CLI. Firstake should recommend these as a stack ("Claude Code + Impeccable + a DESIGN.md") rather than as standalone tools. All are free; the cost is the host tool's plan (Claude Pro $20 includes Claude Code).

Add-on	Type	What it does	Works in	Where to get it / how to use	Skill level
frontend-design (Anthropic, official)	Skill	Baseline design rules that push Claude away from generic "AI-looking" pages	Claude Code, Claude apps	Built in; or `claude plugin add anthropic/frontend-design`	Beginner
Impeccable (Paul Bakaus)	Skill pack	23 design commands (/audit, /polish, /typeset, /impeccable shape) and 27 anti-pattern rules; gives Claude a senior designer's vocabulary	Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Gemini CLI	Download bundle from impeccable.style or copy `.claude` folder into the project; run `/teach-impeccable` once	Intermediate

Add-on	Type	What it does	Works in	Where to get it / how to use	Skill level
taste-skill (Leonxlnx)	Skill pack	Anti-slop frontend design with adjustable dials (variance, motion, density) and style variants: soft, minimalist, brutalist, redesign, image-to-code	Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Windsurf, Copilot	`npx skills add https://github.com/Leonxlnx/taste-skill`	Intermediate
awesome-design-md (VoltAgent)	Design files	Ready-made DESIGN.md files capturing the look of real websites; the agent builds UI that matches	Any agent that reads project files	Copy a site's DESIGN.md into the project root, then prompt "Build a page following DESIGN.md"	Beginner
Playwright CLI (Microsoft)	CLI + skill	Lets the agent open a real browser, click, fill forms and screenshot, so it can check its own work; uses fewer tokens than the MCP version	Claude Code, Copilot, other agents	`/plugin marketplace add microsoft/playwright-cli` then `/plugin install playwright-cli`	Intermediate

Add-on	Type	What it does	Works in	Where to get it / how to use	Skill level
img2threejs	Skill	Rebuilds the object in a photo as a code-only, animatable Three.js 3D model, comparing side by side each pass	Claude Code, Codex, OpenCode	`npx img2threejs install` or clone into `~/.claude/skills/`; run `/img2threejs` with an image	Advanced

Rules for Firstake:

- Only suggest add-ons when the user is already routed to a host tool that supports them, and say plainly that they are for Claude Code, not the regular Claude chat app (skills can also be uploaded in Claude's Settings → Capabilities).
- Track trust signals for each add-on: author, GitHub stars, license and last update. Third-party skills can run code on the user's computer, so Firstake should only recommend well-known ones and say so.
- This list changes weekly. Add-ons go viral on TikTok and GitHub trending first, so Firstake's update process should watch those sources.

Sources: Composio, claude-codex.fr, design-taste, Noqta.

8d. Gaps found by checking GitHub tool directories

Cross-checking this catalog against awesome-generative-ai and awesome-ai-tools turned up these media tools that were missing. Prices are not yet verified; each needs its row completed before launch.

Tool	Category	What it's best at	Why Firstake needs it
PhotoRoom	Image editing	Product photos: remove and replace backgrounds	Top small-business request
Clipdrop	Image editing	Quick cleanup, relight, remove objects	Free fixes before paying for generation
Magnific	Upscaling	Enlarging and sharpening images for print	Posters and print jobs

Tool	Category	What it's best at	Why Firstake needs it
Reve Image	Image generation	Strong prompt-following general images	Another top-tier image option
Photo AI	Headshots	AI portraits of yourself from your own photos	Common student and job-seeker request
Brandmark	Logos	Logo and brand kit generation	Small businesses starting out
Napkin	Diagrams	Turns text into diagrams and visuals	Professors and students making slides
Google Flow	Video	Google's filmmaking interface for Veo, with scenes and ingredients	Easiest way to use Veo 3.1
Pictory / Fliki	Video	Blog post or script to finished video with stock footage and voice	Fast social video without generation costs
Colossyan / D-ID	Avatar video	Talking-head training and explainer videos	Alternatives to HeyGen and Synthesia
Autodesk Flow Studio	Video VFX	Replacing live actors with CG characters	Advanced creators
Stable Audio	Music and sound	Instrumental music and sound effects	Royalty-friendly background audio
Wispr Flow / Whisper	Speech-to-text	Dictation and transcription (Whisper is free and open source)	Captions for videos; older users who prefer speaking

The same directory's "AI graveyard" of discontinued products confirms Sora's shutdown and lists Midjourney Rooms as discontinued in 2026; Firstake's monthly update should re-check that list.

8e. Free access through school or work

The cheapest option is often one the user already has. Firstake should ask students and employees about it before recommending a paid plan, because offers change and some have ended.

Offer	Who qualifies	What it gives
University-provided AI (for example Syracuse University's Claude access through its.syr.edu/getclaude)	Students and staff at that school	Claude without a personal subscription
GitHub Student Developer Pack	Verified students	Free GitHub Copilot Pro, cloud credits
Google AI Pro for Students	College students, where offered	Up to 1 year of Google AI Pro: Gemini, NotebookLM, Veo access in Flow
Microsoft 365 through school or work	Students, employees	Copilot in Word, PowerPoint, Excel
Adobe Creative Cloud through school	Students at participating schools	Firefly credits, Photoshop generative fill

Source: awesome-ai-tools student section; the Syracuse link comes from the IST 314 course slides.

9. Routing cheat sheet

This table is Firstake's first version of the routing logic: user intent → best tool → where to go when credits run out. Firstake asks a question only when the user's request leaves a column ambiguous (for example, personal vs. commercial use).

User wants to...	Best quality pick	Cheapest good pick	Free option	Key question if unclear
Write an essay, email or report	Claude Opus 5.5 (Pro $20)	Claude Sonnet 5.5 / gpt-6.1-sol ($2 / $10 per 1M)	ChatGPT Free, DeepSeek	Audience and length?
High-volume simple text (summaries, tagging)	Claude Sonnet 5.5	GPT-5 nano ($0.05 / $0.40) or Haiku 5.5	DeepSeek app	How many items?

User wants to…	Best quality pick	Cheapest good pick	Free option	Key question if unclear
Research a current topic with sources	Perplexity Pro ($20)	Perplexity Free	Perplexity, NotebookLM for own files	Timeframe?
Realistic photo or photo edit	Nano Banana Pro (AI Pro $19.99)	FLUX 2 ($0.04–0.08/image)	Microsoft Designer, Gemini app	Upload a photo or start fresh?
Artistic or stylized art	Midjourney ($10–30)	Krea Basic ($5.25 annual)	Leonardo, Ideogram free	Reference style?
Poster, logo or image with words	Ideogram 3.0 (~$7)	Ideogram free credits	GPT Image via ChatGPT Free	Exact text?
Short cinematic video with sound	Veo 3.1 ($0.40/s, AI Pro $19.99)	Seedance 2.0 (~$0.03–0.09/s) or Veo 3.1 Lite ($0.05/s, silent)	Kling daily credits	Length, aspect ratio, sound?
Realistic people moving	Kling 3.0 (~$7–37)	Kling Standard	Kling 66 credits/day	—
Animate an existing image	Runway Gen-4.5 (~$0.12/s)	Hailuo 2.3	Hailuo / Kling free credits	Start and end frames?
Commercially safe video for ads	Adobe Firefly Video ($9.99+)	Artlist AI Suite (~$10–13)	—	Paid ad or client work?
Song with vocals	Suno paid (~$8–10)	Suno paid	Suno 50 credits/day (personal only)	Personal or commercial?
Voiceover or voice clone	ElevenLabs Starter ($5)	ElevenLabs Starter	ElevenLabs 10K credits/month	Language and tone?
Marketing website	Framer	Wix free + paid domain	Framer/Wix free subdomain	Brand colors, reference site?
Working web app	Lovable (~$25)	Bolt / Replit free tiers	Lovable daily credits	Do users log in? Data stored?

User wants to…	Best quality pick	Cheapest good pick	Free option	Key question if unclear
Code in an existing project	Claude Code (Pro $20)	GitHub Copilot Pro ($10)	Copilot Free	Language and editor?
Slide deck	Gamma Plus (~$10)	Canva Free	Gamma 400 one-time credits	Audience and slide count?
Talking-avatar video	HeyGen Creator ($29)	HeyGen Avatar III (3 credits/min)	HeyGen 3 videos/month	Script ready?
3D model	Meshy Pro (~$20)	Tripo Pro ($19.90, 3,000 credits)	Hunyuan 3D (~20/day)	For printing or a game?
Automate a repeating task	Zapier (~$20–30)	n8n self-hosted	Zapier 100 tasks, Make 1,000 ops	Which apps?
Many media types in one project	Artlist or Higgsfield	Krea Basic ($5.25)	Freepik daily credits	Which outputs needed?

Never route to: Sora (shut down 2026), Gemini Code Assist individual tier (closed June 2026).

Sources

- SSD Nodes: Free Claude vs ChatGPT vs Gemini
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- Zemith: Free vs paid AI tools 2026
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- WPForms: Text-to-image tools
- Picsart: Best AI image generators
- Higgsfield: Best Sora alternatives
- Rangy: AI video generators compared
- Dupple: Best AI music generators
- Fast.io: Suno alternatives

- Skill Scouter: Lovable review
- Lovable docs: Best practices
- AI Weekly: Best AI coding tools
- Dupple: Best AI presentation tools
- Creatify: HeyGen vs Synthesia
- Krea: Best AI 3D model generators
- Orchestra: Zapier vs n8n

Added in the expanded pass:

- IntuitionLabs: LLM API pricing (Oct 2026)
- invideo: AI video model pricing normalized
- Atlas Cloud: Cheapest AI video APIs
- Provimedia: AI video tools 2026
- GetApp: Artlist pricing
- Dupple: Is Midjourney free (Oct 2026)
- Kive: Krea alternatives
- OpenArt: Multi-model image generators
- Unite.AI: Best AI music generators